



● SPOTIFY AI DJ — A STRATEGIC EXERCISE ●



Two users. Same product.

ONE WANTS TO STEER IT.
ONE WANTS TO BE LEFT ALONE.



● aashithakkar.com ●

1

THE USER WHO STOPPED OPENING IT



I can downvote a song,
but I can't tell it I want
lo-fi today, not
throwback hip-hop.

MAYA, 26 — engaged-but-stuck

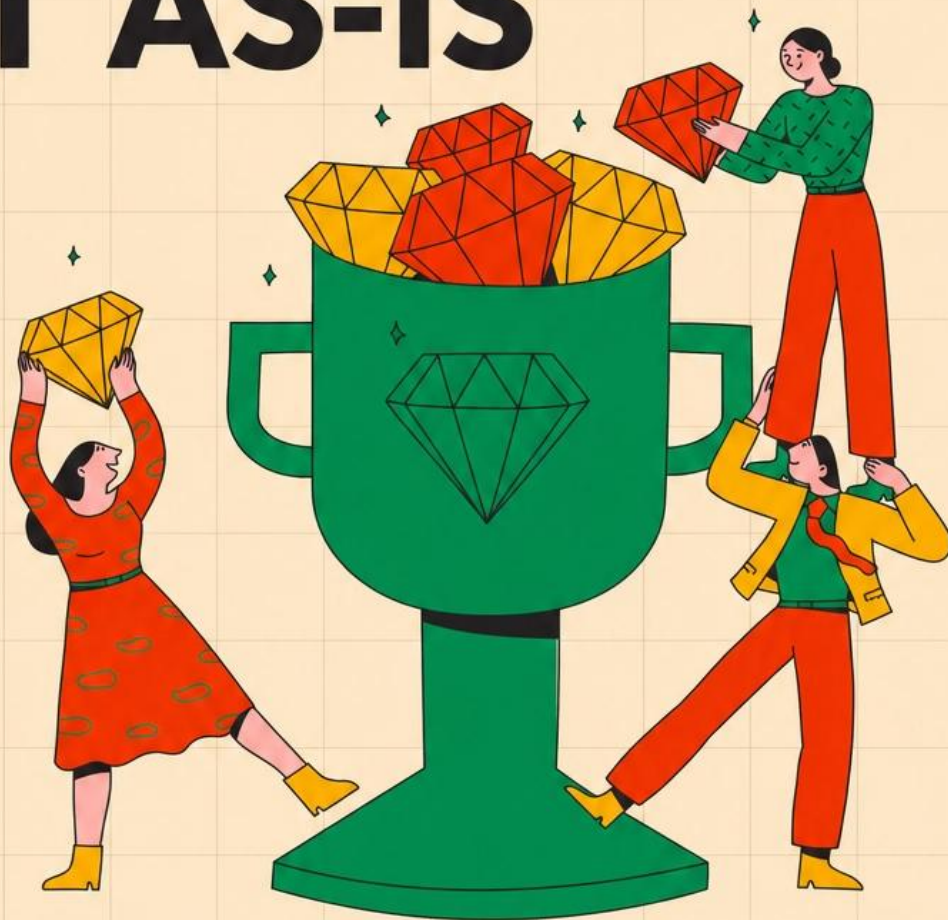
aashithakkar.com



Swipe →

THE USER WHO LOVES IT AS-IS

2



JORDAN, 34 — passive-and-happy

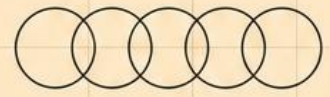
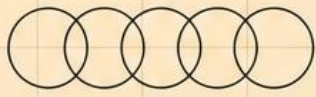
Listens on his commute. NPS 9.



aashithakkar.com



Swipe →



THE CALL

.....



EVOLVE THE THUMBS.

Surface them when the
algorithm is least sure.

aashithakkar.com

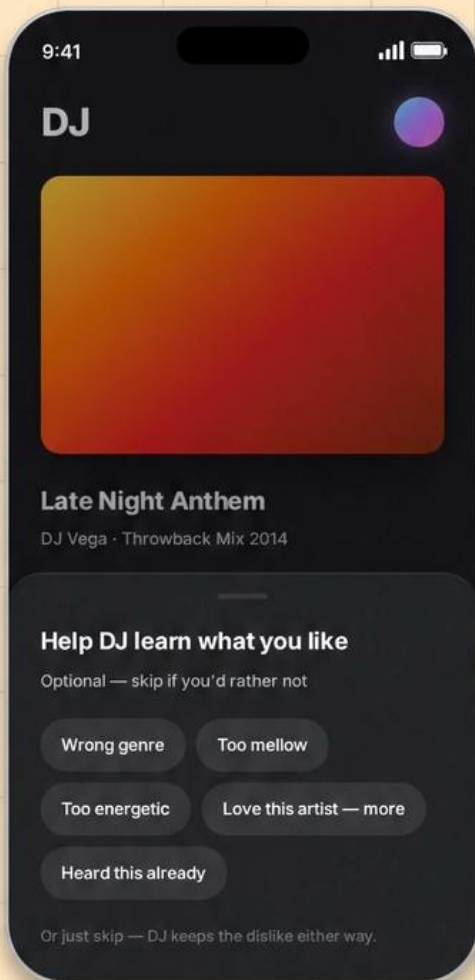


Swipe →

4

PHASE 1 • Q1

....



Long-press → optional reason capture.

Non-modal. Skippable. Helps DJ learn what you actually want.

aashithakkar.com



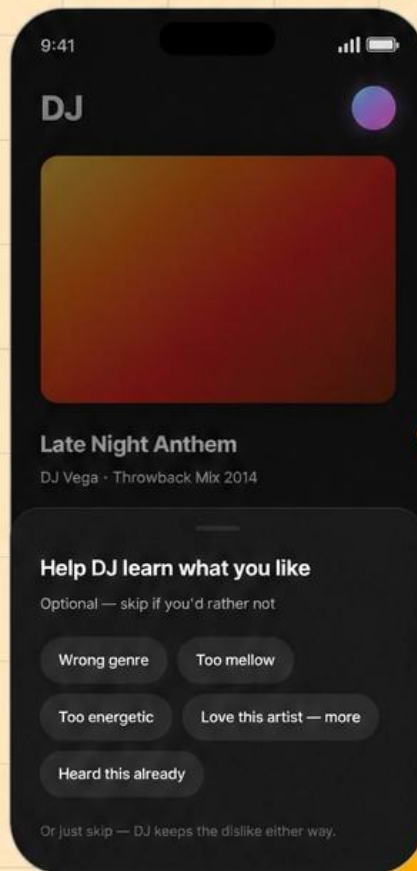
Swipe →

5

PHASE 2 · Q2

● STATE A · IDLE

● STATE B · LONG-PRESS TRIGGERED



Controls visibility scales with inverse model confidence.

Jordan's commute stays calm. Maya's mismatch surfaces the nudge.



aashithakkar.com



Swipe →



THE METRIC DISCIPLINE

....



SHIP AGAINST:

Mid-session
control engagement



REFUSE TO OPTIMIZE FOR:

Likes per session



aashithakkar.com



Swipe →

* THANKS * FOR READING



AASHI THAKKAR

AI Product Manager · Engineer-turned-PM.

I write about what shipping
AI in production actually looks like.

aashithakkar.com

follow for more →